

them. Mozilla Markup is a good example of it. And being a powerful, stable and secure browser helps along the way.

The list of popular add-ons

Till this point, we have looked at Firefox from a philosophical point, with its intentions to solve real problems. However, this is only half the reason Firefox is an adorable browser. The average Joe user (or any regular, non-tech user, with due respects) neither cares for, nor understands these philosophies and ideologies. They want a fast, stable and secure experience over the Web. Firefox delivers on these counts, much like other modern browsers.

However, the add-ons that we talked about earlier help take Firefox a notch forward. They enable you to not only surf the Web with aplomb, but also help you get a ton of stuff done on the side, like managing your tasks, using Twitter, getting weather updates, chatting with friends, managing downloads, and so on, right from inside the browser. We now look at some of the awesome add-ons that make the life of Web developers easier, while adhering to standards and making a more compliant Web application.

Firebug

If you have ever done Web scripting, there are high chances that you have used Firebug to test, prototype and fix your code. With Firebug, you can edit, debug and monitor HTML, CSS and Javascript code on any live Web page.

IE Tab

This add-on embeds Internet Explorer inside a tab in Firefox. It is used for working on the cross-browser compatibility of a Web application, and also helps you surf those Web applications that are “best viewed on Internet Explorer,” without leaving Firefox.

FireFTP

FireFTP is a free, cross-platform FTP/SFTP client built right inside Firefox. If you need to work with multiple documents stored on a remote server, this add-on will help you minimise your effort in fetching the document from the server and re-uploading the changed file.

View Source Chart

This add-on helps you see the source code of a page and inspect its DOM easily. It creates a colour-coded chart of the entire source code, so as to help with visual identification of various sections of the code.

Web Developer Toolbar

The Web Developer add-on adds a toolbar to your Firefox Chrome, which provides you easy access to most functional tools for Web design, including CSS manipulation on a live page, and working with screen resolutions and layouts, amongst others.

User Agent Switcher

This add-on allows you to switch your browser's user agent. Websites identify your browser with the user agent information, and some sites offer different experiences on the basis of the user agent (data on whether the user is surfing from a desktop, Linux or iPhone).

FireShot

This add-on helps you take a screenshot of a Web page and annotate it. The best use-case for such a tool is for design review and feedback, and also to make interface mock-ups.

MeasureIt

This helps you draw a ruler across your screen to measure dimensions of on-screen elements or check the alignment of your page elements.

Ghostery

Ghostery is a useful add-on that helps detect over 400 tracking codes that a developer might place on a website (like analytics, AdSense, etc) to track your activity on that site. The add-on helps you to better understand the factors that relate to your privacy by exposing how these tracking codes work, what information is being collected, and how these companies plan to use your information. It also gives you the control to block these codes and remain invisible on the Web.

GreaseFire

GreaseFire is a GreaseMonkey client for Firefox. Whenever you visit a website that has a compatible script at Userscripts.org, this add-on will help you use that script to override the website in question, and its default website. A very useful tool for some Javascript fun.

While there are many more interesting add-ons out there that are available on the Mozilla Firefox Add-ons website that can be used to enhance your surfing experience, I have only shared the 10 that first crossed my mind. Really, the add-ons give you great power to customise your online experience.

In the end, remember that Firefox is not the only good browser out there, or the only browser with add-ons (though definitely the first to have them). Every browser is strong in certain features, and weak in some others. You will end up choosing your browser after considering what works best for you. The only thing that really matters is that you make an informed choice, and that you don't use a browser for the heck of it.

About Mozilla Firefox

First launched on November 9, 2004, the fiery fox has come a long way in redefining the Internet for people across the globe. The fox has also been very